

Welcome Back!

How Often?

English Básico A1 · Beginner 1 · Unit 5

- Monday, August 10, 2026 · Day 18
- Frequency Adverbs — the foundation of Unit 5

Warm-Up!

Let's remember last week

1

AT, IN, or ON? I get up ____ 6:30. / My birthday is ____ June. / We go shopping ____ Saturday.

2

How much are these shoes? (it's / they're)

3

There ____ two salespeople in the store. (is / are)

Today's Agenda

Unit 5 Begins: Frequency Adverbs

01 What Are Frequency Adverbs?

02 Position: 3 Rules

03 Practice: 3 Activities

04 Write About Your Day

This is the foundation for the rest of Unit 5 — telling time, routines, invitations.

SECTION 1

What Are Frequency Adverbs?

Words that tell us **HOW OFTEN** something happens.

Frequency Adverbs — How Often?

These words tell us HOW OFTEN something happens — con qué frecuencia pasa algo.

always

siempre

100%

usually

usualmente

~80%

sometimes

a veces

~50%

rarely

raramente

~20%

never

nunca

0%

You'll also see: often, frequently, normally, generally, occasionally — don't worry about using these yet.

Position Rule 1: With Action Verbs

Subject + ADVERB + verb

The adverb goes BEFORE the action verb.

I always eat breakfast.

She usually goes running.

They never work on Sundays.

Position Rule 2: With To Be

Subject + TO BE + ADVERB

The adverb comes AFTER "to be" — the opposite order from Rule 1!

She is always late.

He is usually tired.

I am never bored.

⚠ Compare: "I always eat" (action verb, adverb first) vs. "I am always tired" (to be, adverb second).

Position Rule 3: With Auxiliaries

Subject + auxiliary + ADVERB + verb

With don't/doesn't or do/does, the adverb sits between the auxiliary and the verb.

I don't usually eat lunch.

She doesn't always go home.

Do you always get up early?

Definite Frequency: How Many Times?

A different kind of frequency word

Always/usually/sometimes don't give an exact number. These DO: once a day, twice a week, three times a month, every day.

Rule: these go at the END of the sentence — not in the middle like always/usually.

I brush my teeth three times a day.

I see her every day.

We go swimming twice a week.

Never vs. Don't/Doesn't + Ever

Same meaning, two different structures.

NEVER

Already negative — use it in an AFFIRMATIVE sentence, no don't/doesn't.

I never eat meat.

DON'T/DOESN'T + EVER

Same meaning — with the negative structure you already know.

I don't ever eat meat.

⚠ Never is already negative — never combine it with don't/doesn't: ✗ "I don't never go." ✓ "I never go."

EVER in questions — very common in real conversation:

"Do you ever go running?" = "¿Alguna vez sales a correr?"

Can It Start the Sentence?

YES — for emphasis

usually · often · sometimes · occasionally

- Sometimes I go running.
- Usually I eat breakfast at 7.
- Occasionally we go to the beach.

ALMOST NEVER at the start

always · never

- X "Always she works hard."
- ✓ "She always works hard."

This just sounds wrong to a native speaker — keep always/never in their normal position.

This is about what sounds natural, not a hard grammar rule — but native speakers notice immediately when it's broken.

Examples: All 3 Rules Together

always

I always get up at 6:30. · She always eats breakfast. · They are always at the park on Saturday.

rarely

I rarely go to bed late. · He is rarely at home in the morning. · They rarely go shopping on Sundays.

usually

I usually go running in the morning. · We are usually at home in the evening. · He doesn't usually eat lunch.

never

I never eat breakfast late. · She never works on Sundays. · We are never bored in class!

sometimes

I sometimes go swimming after work. · Do you sometimes go to the beach?

SECTION 2

Practice

Three activities — classify, fill in, and combine.

Activity 1: AT, IN, or ON?

Quick review from last week — classify each:

1. 6:30 a.m.

2. Monday

3. the morning

4. November

5. the weekend

6. 5 o'clock

7. the evening

8. Saturday

9. 2025

10. my birthday

Activity 1: Answers

1. 6:30 a.m. → AT

2. Monday → ON

3. the morning → IN

4. November → IN

5. the weekend → ON

6. 5 o'clock → AT

7. the evening → IN

8. Saturday → ON

9. 2025 → IN

10. my birthday → ON

Activity 2: Frequency Adverbs

Complete with always / usually / sometimes / never:

1. I _____ eat breakfast. (100%)

2. She _____ goes running. (~80%)

3. They _____ go to the beach. (0%)

4. He _____ studies at night. (~50%)

5. We _____ work on Sundays. (0%)

Activity 2: Answers

1. I always eat breakfast.

2. She usually goes running.

3. They never go to the beach.

4. He sometimes studies at night.

5. We never work on Sundays.

Activity 3: Combine Both!

Add a frequency adverb AND a preposition:

1. I _____ get up _____ 6:30. (always / at)

2. They _____ go shopping _____ Saturday. (sometimes / on)

3. She _____ studies _____ the morning. (usually / in)

4. He _____ eats lunch _____ 1 o'clock. (always / at)

Activity 3: Answers

1. I always get up at 6:30.

2. They sometimes go shopping on Saturday.

3. She usually studies in the morning.

4. He always eats lunch at 1 o'clock.

SECTION 3

Write About Your Day

See a model first — then write your own.

Model: My Day

Read this example carefully — this is what YOUR writing can look like.

In the morning I always get up at 6:00. I usually eat breakfast at 6:30. I sometimes go running in the park.

In the afternoon I work at the office. I usually have lunch at 12:30. I sometimes go to the supermarket after work.

In the evening I study English at 7:00. I never go to bed late — I always sleep at 10:00!

Your Turn: Write About Your Day

Write 3 sentences minimum — one for morning, afternoon, and evening. Use the model as your guide.

Morning

What do you do in the morning?

I get up at... / I always/usually...

Afternoon

What do you do in the afternoon?

In the afternoon I... / I sometimes...

Evening

What do you do in the evening?

In the evening I... / I never...

4 minutes to write — then share in the chat. A classmate responds with ONE follow-up question!

Great job today!

Frequency adverbs are the foundation for everything coming in Unit 5 — telling time, routines, and invitations.

No homework, no Kahoot today.

Next class:

Telling the Time + Prepositions of Time (review)

See you tomorrow!